Irregular Verbs

Answer key

Name: _____

Date: _____

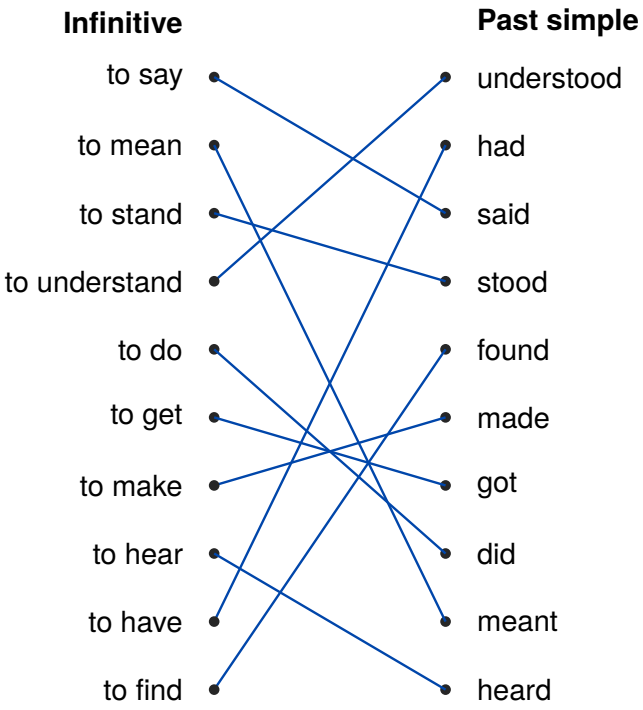
Key terms

Infinitive: the basic form of a verb, usually with *to*: *to sing*.
Past simple: used for finished actions in the past: *Yesterday I sang in the choir.*
Past participle: used with *have*, *has* or *had*: *I have sung in the choir since 2020.*
Irregular verb: a verb whose past forms do not end in *-ed*. You have to learn them by heart.
Pattern: irregular verbs fall into groups. Some have one form for everything (A-A-A), some have two forms the same (A-B-B), in some the past participle is the same as the infinitive (A-B-A) and some have three different forms (A-B-C).

Infinitive	Past simple	Past participle	Pattern
to hit	hit	hit	A-A-A
to sleep	slept	slept	A-B-B
to sing	sang	sung	A-B-C

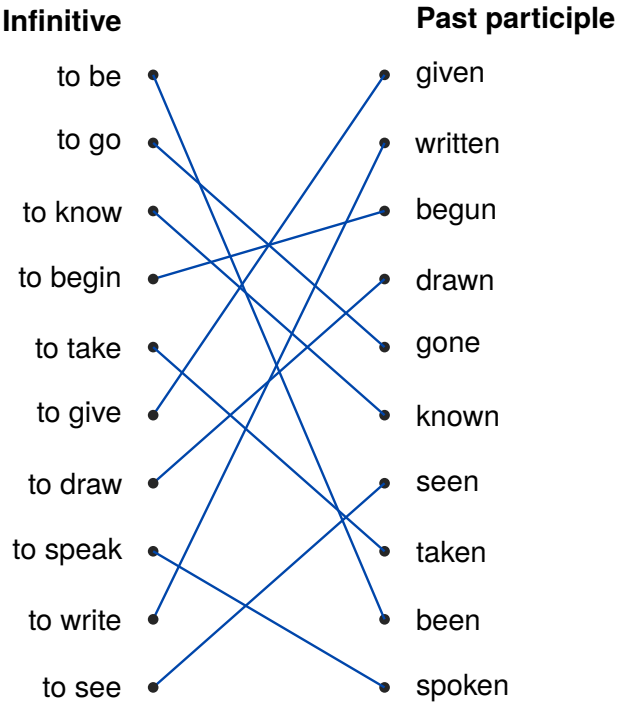
1. Irregular verbs: past simple

Draw a line from each infinitive to its past simple form.



2. Irregular verbs: past participle

Draw a line from each infinitive to its past participle.



3. One form for everything

These verbs have the same form in all three columns. Complete the table. (Careful: the past forms of to read are spelt the same but pronounced like red.)

Infinitive	Past simple	Past participle
to put	*put*	*put*
to let	*let*	*let*
to set	*set*	*set*
to cut	*cut*	*cut*
to read	*read*	*read*

4. Two forms the same (1)

The past simple and the past participle are the same. Complete the table.

Infinitive	Past simple	Past participle
to have	*had*	*had*
to say	*said*	*said*
to get	*got*	*got*
to make	*made*	*made*
to think	*thought*	*thought*
to find	*found*	*found*
to tell	*told*	*told*
to leave	*left*	*left*
to feel	*felt*	*felt*
to bring	*brought*	*brought*
to keep	*kept*	*kept*
to hold	*held*	*held*
to stand	*stood*	*stood*

5. Two forms the same (2)

Now some infinitives are missing, too. Complete the table.

Infinitive	Past simple	Past participle
to hear	*heard*	*heard*
to mean	meant	*meant*
to meet	*met*	*met*
to pay	*paid*	*paid*
to sit	sat	*sat*
to lead	*led*	*led*
to lose	lost	*lost*
to send	*sent*	*sent*
to build	*built*	*built*
to understand	understood	*understood*
to spend	*spent*	*spent*
to buy	bought	*bought*

6. Back to the start

The past participle is the same as the infinitive. Complete the table.

Infinitive	Past simple	Past participle
to come	*came*	*come*
to become	*became*	*become*
to run	*ran*	*run*

7. Three different forms (1)

All three forms are different. Complete the table.

Infinitive	Past simple	Past participle
to be	*was / were*	*been*
to do	*did*	*done*
to go	*went*	*gone*
to know	*knew*	*known*
to take	*took*	*taken*
to see	*saw*	*seen*
to give	*gave*	*given*
to begin	*began*	*begun*
to write	*wrote*	*written*

8. Three different forms (2)

Complete the table. One form is given in each row.

Infinitive	Past simple	Past participle
to speak	*spoke*	*spoken*
to grow	grew	*grown*
to fall	*fell*	*fallen*
to draw	*drew*	drawn
to break	*broke*	*broken*
to drive	drove	*driven*
to eat	*ate*	*eaten*
to choose	*chose*	chosen

9. Odd one out

Three verbs in each line follow the same pattern. Write the one that does not.

1. put cut take let ..... take .....
2. come run go become ..... go .....
3. tell keep write meet ..... write .....
4. speak break buy choose ..... buy .....
5. know grow find draw ..... find .....
6. set sit cut read ..... sit .....
7. bring think drive buy ..... drive .....
8. feel keep eat mean ..... eat .....

10. Past simple

Put the verb in brackets into the past simple.

1. Last summer we ..... went ..... (*to go*) to Scotland.
2. I ..... saw ..... (*to see*) your brother at the station this morning.
3. She ..... bought ..... (*to buy*) a new bike last week.
4. We ..... ate ..... (*to eat*) far too much at the party.
5. My grandfather ..... built ..... (*to build*) this house in 1965.
6. The film ..... began ..... (*to begin*) at eight o'clock.
7. He ..... lost ..... (*to lose*) his keys on the way home.
8. I ..... thought ..... (*to think*) the test was quite easy.
9. My parents ..... met ..... (*to meet*) at university.
10. Who ..... broke ..... (*to break*) the kitchen window?
11. We ..... paid ..... (*to pay*) for the tickets online.

12. The teacher told (*to tell*) us a funny story.

11. Present perfect

Put the verb in brackets into the past participle.

1. Have you ever eaten (*to eat*) sushi?
2. I have known (*to know*) her since we were children.
3. She has written (*to write*) three books about birds.
4. We haven't seen (*to see*) that film yet.
5. Has anyone taken (*to take*) my pen?
6. The temperature has fallen (*to fall*) below zero.
7. He has driven (*to drive*) all the way from Glasgow.
8. They have chosen (*to choose*) a name for the baby.
9. I have never spoken (*to speak*) to our new neighbours.
10. Have you done (*to do*) your homework?
11. It has been (*to be*) a very long day.
12. My aunt has given (*to give*) me a lot of good advice.

12. Past simple or past participle?

Put the verb in brackets into the correct form.

1. When I was ten, I grew (*to grow*) ten centimetres in one year.
2. Look how tall you have grown (*to grow*)!
3. She left (*to leave*) the office at six o'clock.
4. Has the train already left (*to leave*)?
5. He fell (*to fall*) off his bike yesterday.
6. Somebody has broken (*to break*) my glasses.

7. We ..... *came* ..... (*to come*) home very late last night.

8. I'm so glad you have ..... *come* ..... (*to come*) to visit us.

9. I ..... *ran* ..... (*to run*) five kilometres this morning.

10. Have you ever ..... *run* ..... (*to run*) a marathon?

11. Last year my cousin ..... *became* ..... (*to become*) a teacher.

12. My little sister has ..... *become* ..... (*to become*) very good at chess.

13. I ..... *heard* ..... (*to hear*) a strange noise in the night.

14. Have you ..... *heard* ..... (*to hear*) the news?

13. Choose the verb

Choose a verb from the box and put it into the past simple. Use each verb once.

to bring	to feel	to hold	to keep	to lead	to send	to sit	to spend	to stand

1. We ..... *sat* ..... in the garden all afternoon.

2. She ..... *sent* ..... me a postcard from Rome.

3. I ..... *felt* ..... very tired after the long walk.

4. The guide ..... *led* ..... us through the old town.

5. He ..... *held* ..... the baby very carefully.

6. They ..... *spent* ..... all their money on a new car.

7. My friend ..... *brought* ..... a cake to the party.

8. We ..... *stood* ..... in the rain for an hour.

9. She ..... *kept* ..... all his letters in a box.

14. Find the mistake

Each sentence has one wrong verb form. Write the correct form.

1. Yesterday I *buyed* a new jacket. ..... *bought* .....
2. She has *wrote* a letter to the newspaper. ..... *written* .....
3. We *goed* to the beach last weekend. ..... *went* .....
4. Have you ever *drove* a lorry? ..... *driven* .....
5. He *thinked* the answer was wrong. ..... *thought* .....
6. I have *knew* him for years. ..... *known* .....
7. The children have *ate* all the biscuits. ..... *eaten* .....
8. In the end, he *choosed* the red one. ..... *chose* .....
9. The glass has *fell* off the table. ..... *fallen* .....
10. I *seen* him in town yesterday. ..... *saw* .....

15. Anna's Saturday

Read the story and put the verbs in brackets into the past simple.

Last Saturday, Anna got (*to get*) up early. She had (*to have*) a quick breakfast and put (*to put*) on her coat. Then she drove (*to drive*) to the station and took (*to take*) the train to the city. On the train she read (*to read*) a magazine and wrote (*to write*) a few postcards. In the city she met (*to meet*) her old friend Sam. They sat (*to sit*) in a café and spoke (*to speak*) for hours. Sam told (*to tell*) her all about his new job. Later they went (*to go*) to a bookshop, and Anna found (*to find*) a book that she knew (*to know*) her brother would love, so she bought (*to buy*) it for him. In the evening she came (*to come*) home tired but happy and fell (*to fall*) asleep on the sofa.

16. Your turn: last weekend

Write five sentences about what you did last weekend. Use at least five different irregular verbs from this worksheet.

17. Your turn: have you ever . . . ?

Write three sentences about things you have or have never done. Use to eat, to see and to be.